

Community Library Website

User Guide/Walkthrough

COSC 360 - Team 18

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Github Link - <https://github.com/yta3216/CommunityLibrary.git>

Overview/Vision

The Community Library project is a website designed to facilitate book sharing within our community. The application allows users to list books, borrow books, and engage in discussions through a chat system. The vision of the project is to create a seamless and free platform for community members to share books and foster cultural development through reading. Ultimately, we do not wish to become a book marketplace; our goal is to reduce waste while promoting reading experiences in an accessible way for a vibrant and collaborative community.

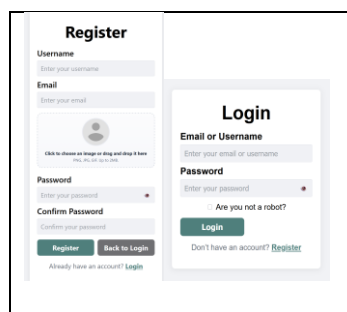
Test Accounts

The following accounts can be used to test different roles. All accounts are pre-loaded in database.

Role	Username	Password
Registered User	wong	wong11
Registered User	hong	hong123
Registered User	samuell	samuell
Administrator	admin	admin

Walkthrough 1 – Registration and Login

This walkthrough covers account creation and authentication

	Step 0: The unregistered home page is where all new users will start their journey on our platform. Here they have very limited functionality, only being able to see the books available but not able to do anything besides that. Step 1: Register form will appear and will require you to fill in a username, email address and password. Submitting the form will create your account. Step 2: Login using the credentials from the test accounts or your newly created account. You will be redirected to the home page as an authenticated user or the admin dashboard if using admin credentials.
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Walkthrough 2 – User Profile

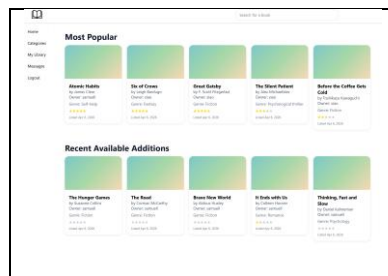
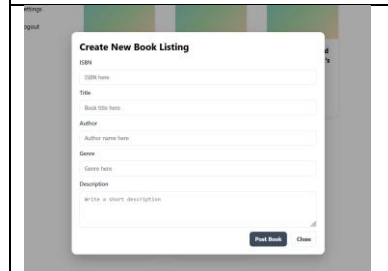
Step 1: Once logged in you will be directed to registered home page. In the top left corner click your profile picture.

Step 2: Upload a profile picture for your profile.

Step 3: You are also able to edit your profile details as well as log out.

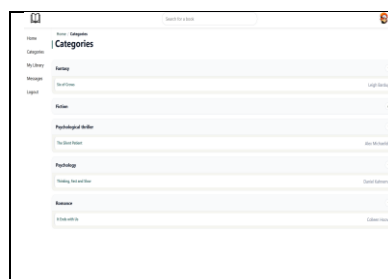
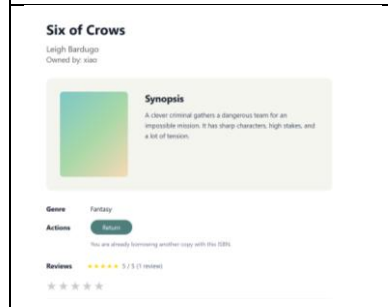
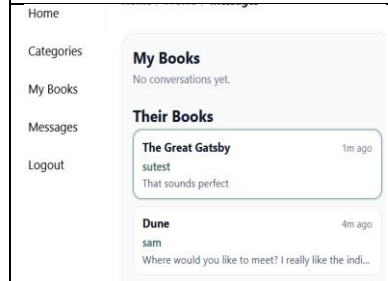
Walkthrough 3 – Listing a Book

Any authenticated user can create book listings

	Step 1: After logging in as a registered user (eg. hong), you will be redirected to the core of our platform. Users can search for books, browse them, check the most popular, and access pretty much all other features of the website. The goal was to create a centralized gateway to all parts of the platform; not only did it need to be functionally good, but it also needed to be aesthetically pleasing and simple, all of which we believe we have achieved with this home page design.
	Step 2: Click the “Create new listing” button in the right bottom corner. Step 3: Create book listing form will appear. Fill in the ISBN, book title, author, genre and a brief description (all information required). Submit the form and your book listing will be created. Step 4: Your book listing will appear in the home page in recent available addition and all available books. <i>Note:</i> All books are automatically owned (immutably) and held by the listing creator.

Walkthrough 4 – Borrowing a book (Full cycle)

Borrowing a book is coordinated entirely by the chat system between 2 users.

	3a: Book searching Step 1: At the top navigation bar users have access to a search function to help them search for specific books they are looking for. Step 2: Navigate to the “categories” page from the left navigation bar for categorized book listings. These are collapsible items to help users find books from their favorite genres more easily. <i>Note:</i> Any oddly formatted genres can be easily found under ‘Others’.
	3b: Initiate Borrow Request (as Borrower) Step 1: After finding a book you wish to borrow, clicking on the book card will take you to a detailed book page with book details, reviews and a button to initiate a borrow request. Step 2: Click on the “borrow”, this will prompt you to write a message saying that you want to borrow the book. Borrow requests will start a conversation with the book owner where you can arrange the details of your borrowing. If book is not available, it will prevent this.
	3c: Respond and confirm the lend (as Owner) Step 1: Navigate to “messages”. You should see a new message from the user that initiated the borrow request. Step 2: Open the conversation and chat to come to an agreement for borrowing details (eg. where to meet for book exchange). Step 3: Other users can still request to borrow if its not lent. When ready to lend it to someone click “lend book” at top right in chat.

3d. Confirm Return (as Borrower)

Step 1: Open the same initial chat. If you don't remember which chat, you can go to "My Library" page for details (explained below)

Step 2: Chat with the owner of the book for book returning details.

Step 3: Once everything is settled and the book is no longer with the borrower, click "return book" button at the top right corner. This will make the book status available to borrow for other users.

3e. Leaving a book review (as Borrower)

Step 1: In the book details page, you can give the book and your experience with the borrow a rating. You can type in a review and submit to leave a review. Most popular books sorting are based on user ratings.

Walkthrough 5 – My Library User Dashboard (functionality guide)

Step 1: Navigate to "my library" from left navigation. There will be a dashboard with borrowing, listing, reviews and relevant details with graph analysis.

Step 2: Full listing of books you listed is shown in the table below, borrowed and available books.

Step 3: You can change the status of the book available/unavailable as well as delete/edit your book listing.

Step 4: Navigate to "borrowed books" in title heading to view all the books you have borrowed from others. The chats are directly linked here if you want to chat more with your lender.

Step 5: Navigate to "my reviews" to view your review history (review you left on other's listings).

Walkthrough 6 – Administrator Features

Login as user admin (password admin) to access exclusive admin panel.

User Management – Book Management - Reports

Step 1: After login, you will be redirected to admin dashboard. You will see user analytics and recent listings as well as quick actions.

Step 2: Click "manage books" or "books" at top navigation, redirecting to manage books page. Admin can search for books, filter by status, change availability/status, create/delete book listings from all users.

Step 3: Click "manage users" from dashboard or "users" at top navigation, redirecting to manage user page. Admin can search for users, filter by role, suspend/activate accounts, promote user to admin, delete accounts of all users. When clicking on each user row an expandable row will appear with details of user's review history, listings and borrowed books.

Step 4: Click "report" at top navigation, redirecting to reports page. Admin will see detailed analytics of the platform over time with user usage and sign ups. Admin can filter and view progression over different periods of time.

Unique Feature to Highlight

- ❖ Chat driven borrow flow, persistent chat history
- ❖ Admin/user reports with charts, admin role cycling
- ❖ ISBN duplicate guard: system prevents user from holding two copies of the same ISBN